What You Wish for

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What You Wish for

by Xenakis (IceRosesCrown)

Summary

The day before the Winter Solstice party organized by Frosta, ✨ something ✨ happens that makes Castaspella and Shadow Weaver switch bodies…

Among other things, Catra gets a word with "Castaspella" only to figure out the truth faster than a racing car.

Notes

This was my entry for the Spop Icebreaker Zine we did in the Spop Creative Flex server for 2025's end of the year, and I *just* remembered I could also post it here XD

Anyways, the max was 2000 words, and I wrote exactly that, but it did feel a bit rushed. A nice challenge tho

Mandatory Thanks Rosemarie for hosting <3

Btw, here's the link to download the Zine! :D

I hope you enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

The Winter Solstice was almost upon them, and all of Etheria was excited for the ball organized by Princess Frosta.

It would be the first grand party since the restoration of peace. Since the end of the war…

However, some people were restless. Like King Micah, who went to take a stroll through Mystacor to relax a bit.

He was once again thinking about how odd it was to have Shadow Weaver around, doing chores and and tasks as some sort of punishment… He found it quite lenient.

Sometimes he wondered how his sister was taking it, having to oversee the old woman. And right as he thought about her, he saw Castaspella just a few meters away.

—Hey, Sis!— he called, but she didn't look back. Strange, but well, he could still approach. —Morning! Didn't you hear me?

—Uh? Ah, I didn't— she replied.

She sounded quite strange.

—Are you alright? You seem a bit tense.

—I'm *fine*.

She was definitely on edge.

—You're acting strange, Sis. Are you sure there's nothing you need to talk about?

—Micah, I…— she began, serious, but got distracted as a group of children running around suddenly caught her attention.

—Oh, they are at it again— he commented, noticing them. —And here at the edge it's so…

—All of you, stop right there!— Castaspella suddenly exclaimed, making them freeze in place. Even Micah felt the need to stand straight. —You are *not* supposed to run around these parts, it's extremely dangerous— she chastised them. —Unless you want to face punishment, you better stick to walking from now on— she concluded.

—Yes, Head Sorceress— they all replied, ashamed, before walking away.

—Wow— he uttered. That manner of speech and posture was… No, impossible. —I- What was that?

Right… She had to hold back a flinch as she realized what she had just done.

She forgot for a moment… that she's *not in her body*.

Shadow Weaver couldn't believe she had been so careless again.

—Was I wrong?— she asked, clearing her throat and trying to sound less commanding.

—Well, you're just looking out for them. The punishment part was a bit… too much, but I'm surprised with how well you managed it! I had… never seen you like that— he explained.

—Of course you haven't— she muttered.

—Speaking of, have you noticed how humble Shadow Weaver's been acting today? It's so weird, isn't it?— he joked, teasingly elbowing her.

The old woman had to catch herself for a moment.

He was being so nice it almost moved her to tears…

She had to remind herself she was in his sister's body.

—Ah… pay it no mind— she sighed, waving a hand dismissively. This was getting out of control. She had to find Castaspella. —I have to go.

—A-alright. See you tomorrow at the ball?

—Sure.

Meanwhile, in another part of the island…

—I-I'm sorry!— Castaspella exclaimed, out of instinct, forgetting she's on Shadow Weaver's body.

—You…— the acolyte began, but interrupted himself as he processed it for a second. —Did you just *apologize*!? Fo-for bumping into me!?

—N-no, I-I…— she began, before clearing her throat. —Forget it. I don't owe you an explanation — she managed to say, forcing herself to stand straight and to speak more severely.

However, Shadow Weaver in Castaspella's body had just found her, in time to hear the whole thing. Immediately, she stalked at them, grabbed "Shadow Weaver" by the arm, and pulled her away.

—What do you think you're doing!?— she reproached her, as soon as they were out of earshot.

—I'm *sorry*! I forget!

—Stop saying that, for starters!— the woman ordered, seething.

—You're being all severe and nasty to everyone too, why don't *you* stop it!?

—Ah… Never mind. It's not like I have any reputation to ruin…— Shadow Weaver sighed, placing her hands on her temples, realizing how unfamiliar the touch felt in this body. —Let's go over what happened…

—We were in a cave, some crystals shone, we yelled… And this morning we were like this!— Castaspella summarized.

—Yes, but did you notice *what* we yelled?

—I said that you should be more like me, and you… that I should be more like you.

—So?

—What? You mean it's our fault!?

—Probably. I may not be able to use sorcery anymore, but I still know a thing or two about magic…

—Wait, but…— Castaspella began, yet interrupted herself. She tried to perform a spell and, much to her surprise, despite being in Shadow Weaver's body, she could actually draw it. —Try it!

The woman tried casting the same spell as her, but it didn't work.

Not a speck of magic.

—Great. This is just *great*.

—How are we going to explain this!?

—We can't. But we can go to that cave again and investigate…

—Now!?

—Would you like to risk more time in my body? Or me having to perform magic and making a fool of *you* by being unable to?— Shadow Weaver reminded her.

—Fine, fine. Let's go before someone asks.

Unfortunately for them, their investigation was fruitless.

And if that wasn't enough, Castaspella remembered there would be a Council meeting soon.

She considered calling in sick, but she had been seen all day and was fine… So Shadow Weaver suggested going together and pretend "Shadow Weaver" was there as counselor of sorts.

That way, they wouldn't fuck up…

Or so they thought.

Unfortunately, Shadow Weaver, in Castaspella's body, lost her temper mid-way through the session. She pushed away a stack of papers and stormed off before anyone could stop her, and the real Head Sorceress was left in shock.

Now everyone was looking at her.

She had to think like the old woman, act like her, and *avoid* apologizing.

—How pathetic— she began, standing straight, proud. —You should be ashamed of having pushed her to such extreme! I see this Council hasn't changed since my time here— she improvised. —But worry not, *I'll* go and fix the mess you made.

With that, she walked away, and only once she was alone did she drop the proud posture.

That had gone better than expected…

As she went to find Shadow Weaver, she couldn't help thinking, to her dismay, about how *well* it felt to speak her mind and insult them to their faces.

After discussing what to do if the following morning they were still like this, the women decided to go to sleep early, to avoid more trouble. Then, mixing up for a moment which room to go to, they finally went to sleep in unfamiliar beds.

As expected, they woke up and were still on the other's body.

Resigned, they prepared as agreed for the ball that would start that evening, and tried to avoid unnecessary interactions the whole day. This meant finding excuses to go on their own to the Kingdom of Snows, lest Micah noticed something strange during the long trip there.

However, they crossed paths when leaving Mystacor and ended up traveling together. If anyone asked, it was just part of Castaspella's duty as Shadow Weaver's supervisor…

Upon arrival, they were greeted by the beautifully decorated palace. Glistening decorations, carefully set tables, nice music and soft lights…

After admiring it all for a moment, the women went on their separate ways and tried their best to act like the other when encountering familiar people, which proved *difficult*.

Eventually, they gravitated towards each other and away from the crowd.

It was safer, more comfortable.

But people were watching, so they came and went for a few hours, pretending to be mingling and "casually" meeting.

Meanwhile, somewhere nearby, Catra was enjoying the Winter Solstice Ball with her friends, hearing some story Perfuma was telling, when something caught her attention.

She didn't expect Shadow Weaver to attend the ball… but, on closer look, she looked kind of strange.

The old woman seemed to be talking with the Head Sorceress of Mystacor, and even though she couldn't make out what they were saying, she could *see* Shadow Weaver getting flustered and then huffy about whatever the sorceress was telling her.

But that wasn't all.

Glimmer's aunt was standing straight and proud, Catra could swear she was being as condescending as only Shadow Weaver could be.

Almost as if…

No, it couldn't be.

After a moment, when the old woman walked away, she decided to check on the sorceress.

—He-hey, Castaspella, right?

—Catra?— she asked back, surprised. —Do you… need something?

Time to test her theory.

—Yeah, I saw you were… talking with Shadow Weaver and… I wanted to ask… how's she doing?

—You- So you still… care about her?

—I don't know why, but… yeah. I'm stupid like that— she sighed, looking down.

—No. You're just… good. Better than her— the sorceress replied, reaching out and tilting Catra's face up in a way that felt all too familiar. —Always were…

Holy shit.

—It's- You're- *How*?— she stammered. —You *swapped bodies*, didn't you!?

"Castaspella's" expression confirmed it as she only looked away, seemingly ashamed.

—I have to go.

—Wait— Catra reacted, grabbing her by the arm for a second and letting go almost immediately. —Did you… mean what you just said?

The same expression again.

She only nodded briskly, and walked away, almost missing Catra's muttered appreciation.

Meanwhile, Castaspella in Shadow Weaver's body had been approached by some of Mystacor's councillors.

—Excuse us, but we wanted to ask if you… managed to appease Castaspella.

Oh, here we go…

—I- Uh, ye-yes— she began. She had to improvise. —She asked me to tell you she… apologizes… for reacting like that— she first said. But then thought better about it and added —But she won't apologize for getting angry. Your lack of respect offended her. As it has many times before. She may be young but she earned her position.

—We never meant to disrespect her— one of them replied.

—We didn't know she felt that way… She never mentioned it.

—Now you know— Castaspella replied, trying to stand straight like the old woman. —She won't keep tolerating it.

—Of course. We-we'll keep it in mind— the third councillor assured her. —We appreciate you letting us know.

She wasn't expecting that.

She had been honest and it… went well?

—We need to talk— Shadow Weaver suddenly surprised her, grabbing her by the arm and taking her to a secluded table where they sat across each other. —Catra knows.

—What!?

—She recognized me. Somehow…

—We need to fix this— Castaspella sighed. —I feel so different, being in your body and acting like you…

—Trust me, same here— she scoffed. —I was… too honest to Catra. *Vulnerable*. I didn't think…

—But that's good!

—I don't know.

—It is— Castaspella gently insisted, holding her hands. —I told some councillors how I really feel, saying "you" told me to, and they took it well. I'm different but not… in a bad way.

—Right…

As they quietly looked at their joined hands, midnight finally came and, with it, *change*.

They felt numb for a moment before realizing they were back in their own bodies.

—Did you- Oh! I'm me!— Castaspella cheered, squeezing the old woman's hands.

—At last, my mask again— Shadow Weaver sighed, without pulling away.

Then they noticed their hands again.

—I…— the Head Sorceress began. —I think I'll have to get you a new supervisor— she said, smiling shyly, not letting go and hoping Shadow Weaver wouldn't either.

—Why?

—I realized… I may be… feeling something I'd like to explore. But I can't do it while I have to oversee you.

The old woman was shocked for a moment, yet allowed herself to soften a bit.

—I know what you mean.

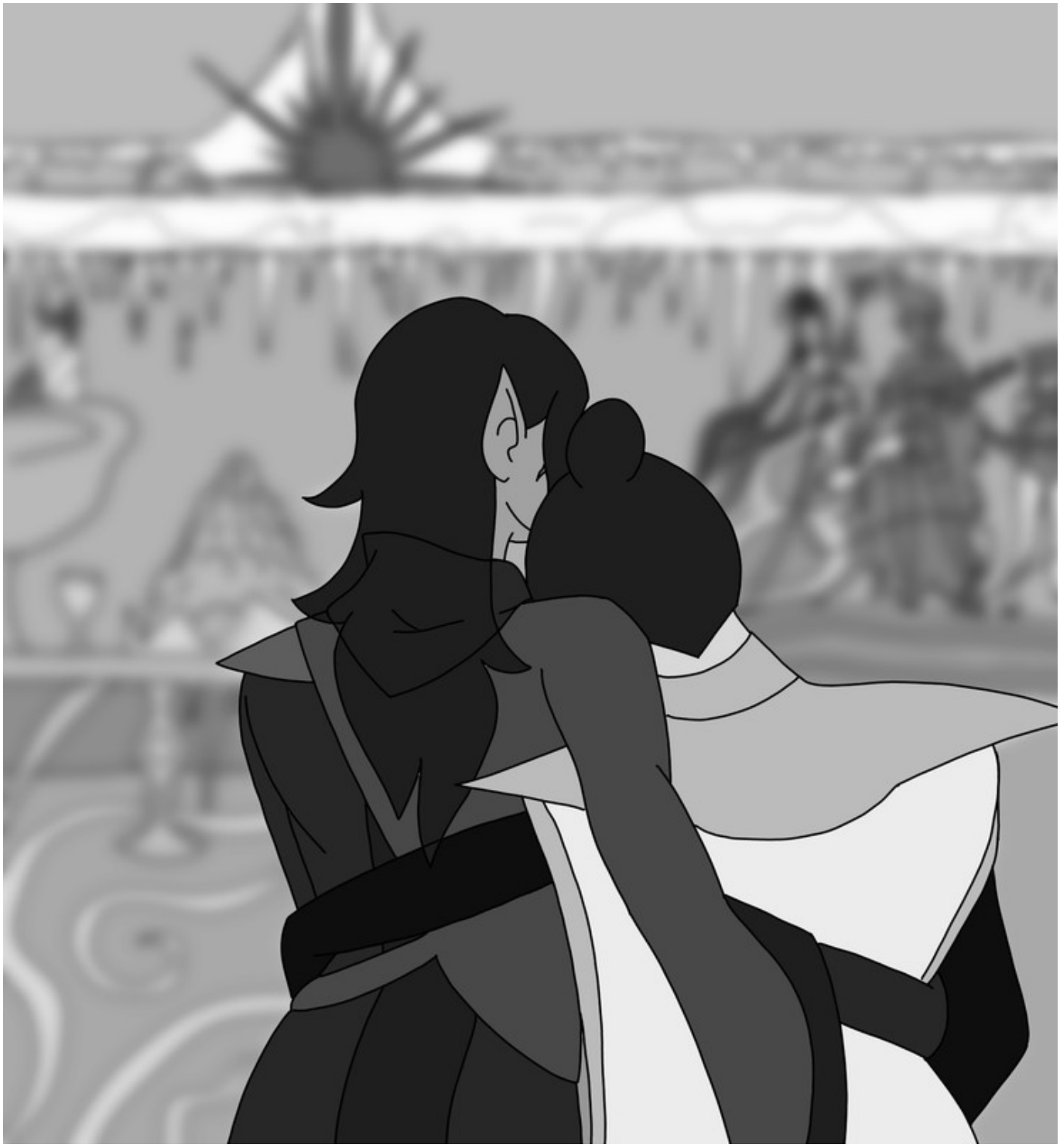
Castaspella's relief was evident in her face.

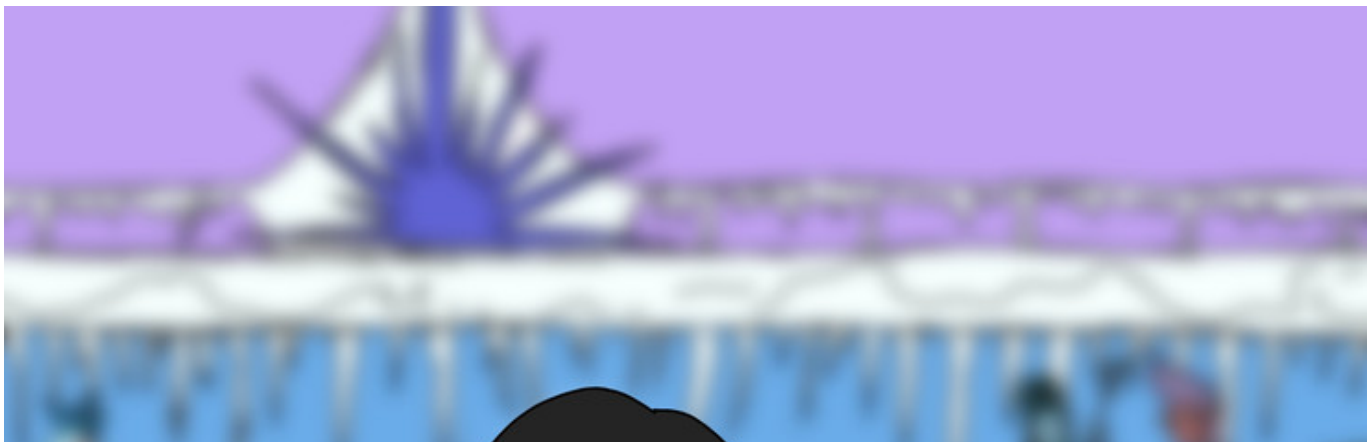
Giggling, she let go of her hands only for a moment, to move her chair next to Shadow Weaver's; then held them again, while resting her head on the old woman's shoulder.

And Shadow Weaver allowed it.

Was it the cave? The Solstice?

Regardless, it had been for the best.







End Notes

Many thanks for reading, please check the rest of the entries, everything was fantastic, and ofc, the art *chef kiss*

See you around!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!